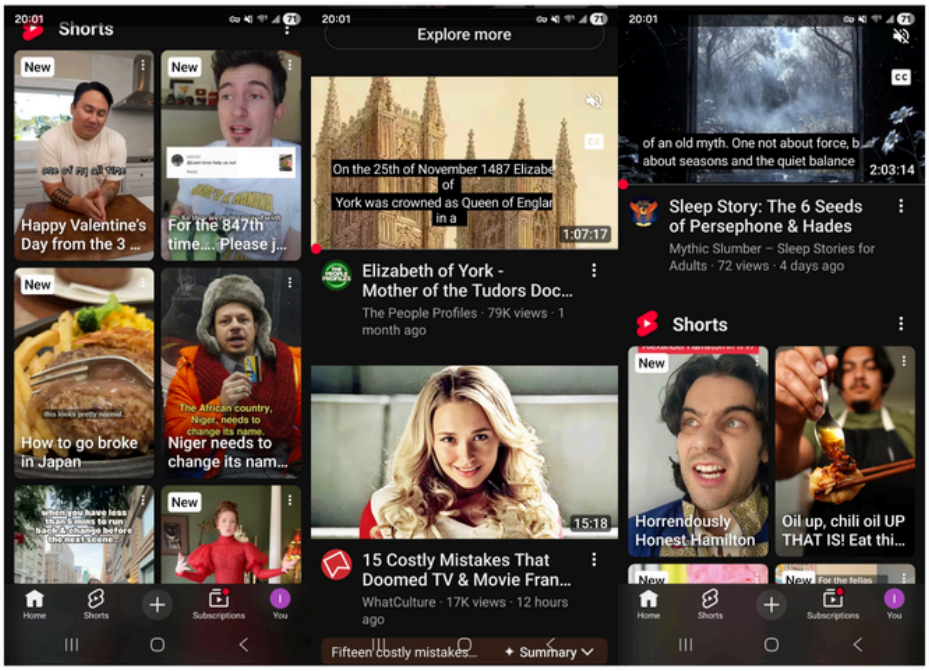
IG
Imani Glasco
Feb 15 11:40pm

For this experiment, I used a phenomenological approach to examine YouTube's recommendation system. Rather than trying to figure out how the algorithm technically works, I focused on my experience using it and how my homepage responded to changes in my viewing behavior. Before I started, my recommendations were mostly cooking videos, food creators, WatchMojo and WhatCulture lists, and history content. Many of the suggested videos came from creators I already follow, so my feed felt stable and predictable. It reflected long-term patterns and did not seem to fluctuate much from day to day.

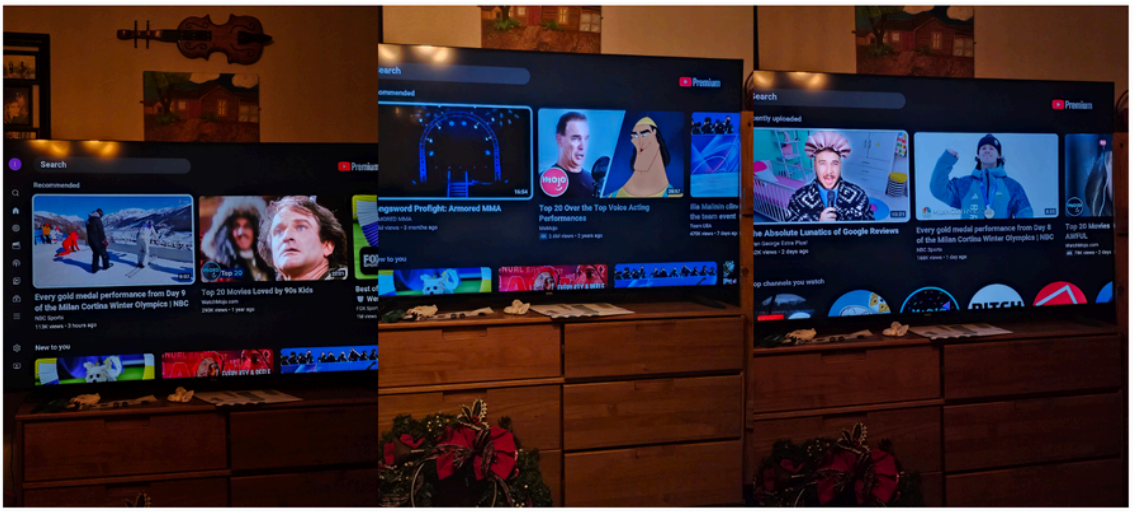
I then watched a compilation of Super Bowl ads, the full halftime performance, and a highlight reel from this year's game. After doing that, my homepage began to shift. I did not receive more football videos specifically, but I did start seeing more sports-related content, especially recent Olympic videos. These appeared roughly every third recommendation. It felt like YouTube registered a temporary interest in sports but interpreted it broadly rather than precisely. My usual cooking and list-style content was still present, but it was now mixed with this new category.

What really stood out to me was how quickly the algorithm reacted. Even a short session of watching different content was enough to influence my homepage. At the same time, it did not completely replace my established viewing habits, which shows that my accumulated history still carries significant weight. The recommendations felt reactive but generalized, grouping my behavior into "sports" instead of specifically football. This experience made the algorithm feel less neutral and more like it was actively shaping what I saw. Even brief behavior shifts can begin redirecting the algorithm, which shows how recommendation systems continuously interpret and adjust to our interests based on minimal input.

Before:



After:



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Feb 22 10:28pm | Last edited Feb 22 11pm | Last reply Feb 22 11:06pm

View History

Rule of Thirds/Upside Down Camera | Rule of Space (Motion) | Macro-Photograhphy | Dynamic Portrait

I really enjoyed this lab. Learning how to better utilize lighting and shadows showed me how quickly mood can be communicated through an image. When shooting for lifestyle or food campaigns, brighter lighting can help create a clean and cheerful aesthetic, while more dramatic or fashion-focused content can benefit from deeper shadows to create an edgier feeling. Being intentional with lighting can also reduce the amount of editing needed later and help images stand out in a feed.

Practicing with blur and shutter speed has also illustrated how movement can be used in social media campaigns. A shallow depth of field can isolate products and guide attention more deliberately. Adjusting shutter speed to capture motion can add energy to fitness or travel content and make it feel less staged and more organic.

I was also able to see how angles and poses can be used strategically as well. Shooting at a low angle can make a subject appear powerful, while eye-level shots can conjure up a more authentic and relatable feeling. Even small choices like a slight tilt or an overhead composition can shape how an image is perceived.

Using leading lines, framing, and the rule of thirds allows for more control over how viewers move through an image. The rule of space can also help create more natural-looking motion shots that can be used for action heavy brands like vehicle, sports, and outdoor brands. Lastly, macro-photography would be useful for detail-heavy images that highlight texture in food, skincare, or fashion products which can increase a brands perceived quality.

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Imani Glasco

Mar 8 5:56pm | Last reply Mar 8 11:12pm

Not every path is a straight line.

I was accepted to TXST as a computer science major but switched to DMI just before orientation. I worried I might have made the wrong decision, but the first time I walked down this hallway I realized I was finally on the right path. After such a long journey, it's incredible to finally feel at home.

Share your photos and stories about why you love SJMC.

#IloveSJMC #FoundMyPlace

I knew from the jump that I wanted to use a photo of Old Main for this assignment because it is one of my favorite places on campus. On Wednesday, I walked around the building taking photos from several different angles. I experimented with different perspectives, including trying to frame Old Main through the legs of the LBJ statue. At the time, many of the photos looked good on my phone, so I assumed I would have something usable.

When I got home and reviewed them more carefully, I realized that although some images were visually interesting, they did not really convey what I wanted them to. Because of that, I struggled to write a caption that felt authentic. The photos did not clearly communicate why I love SJMC, which made it difficult to connect the image and the message.

Because of this, I approached the shoot differently on Friday. I decided to focus on the interior of Old Main. I had taken one or two interior photos on Wednesday that I liked, but I had moved on too quickly without exploring the space further. Friday morning before my 10 a.m. class, I sat in the middle of the hallway and spent more time experimenting with the composition instead of just taking a few quick shots.

To take the final image, I photographed the hallway with my phone upside down, which helps me frame photos more precisely. I also focused on incorporating leading lines, since that is one of the composition techniques I had practiced the least. The arches, lights, and reflections guide the viewer's eye down the corridor toward the staircase and emphasize the depth of the space. Once I captured an image that conveyed the feeling of being in that hallway, writing the caption became much easier because the photo itself reflected why I genuinely love SJMC.

IG

Imani Glasco

Mar 1 6:29pm | Last reply Mar 1 7:33pm

Facebook: 1440 × 1800 (4:5)

Instagram: 1080 × 1080 (1:1)

Pinterest: 1000 × 1500 (2:3)

For this campaign, I developed the concept “Untamed Refinement” around Johnnie Walker’s Year of the Horse Blue Label limited edition release. I selected existing brand imagery that emphasized the contrast between the power symbolized by the horse and the craftsmanship represented by Blue Label. By choosing darker, cinematic visuals and pairing them with minimal typography, the campaign maintains Johnnie Walker’s established luxury identity while highlighting the exclusivity and cultural significance of the release.

For the Instagram ad, I used a 1080 × 1080 (1:1) square format, which aligns with the platform’s traditional feed layout. Because Instagram is highly scroll-driven and mobile-focused, the design prioritizes immediate visual impact and clear hierarchy to capture attention quickly. For the Facebook ad, I designed the advertisement in a 1440 × 1800 (4:5) portrait format, which occupies more vertical space in the feed and supports a more cinematic composition. The taller aspect ratio allows for stronger visual balance between product, background, and typography. For the Pinterest ad, I used a 1000 × 1500 (2:3) vertical format, as the platform favors tall, discovery-oriented content. The design emphasizes product imagery with restrained typography to align with Pinterest’s aspirational browsing behavior.

Facebook and Instagram use CPM, CPC and CPA. On Instagram CPC typically ranges from about $0.40–$2.00, and average CPM around $5–$15 or more depending on targeting and competition. Facebook CPC prices vary widely but tend to be in the range of around $0.30–$2.00, and CPM can be between $1–$10+. For both platforms, CPA pricing varies significantly depending on industry, targeting, and conversion objectives. Pinterest uses CPM and CPC. Their average CPC ranges from $0.10–$1.50, and average CPM can be up to about $1.50 for visual ad placements. For this campaign, CPM would be the most strategic choice, as the goal is broad visibility and premium brand positioning rather than driving immediate clicks.

IG

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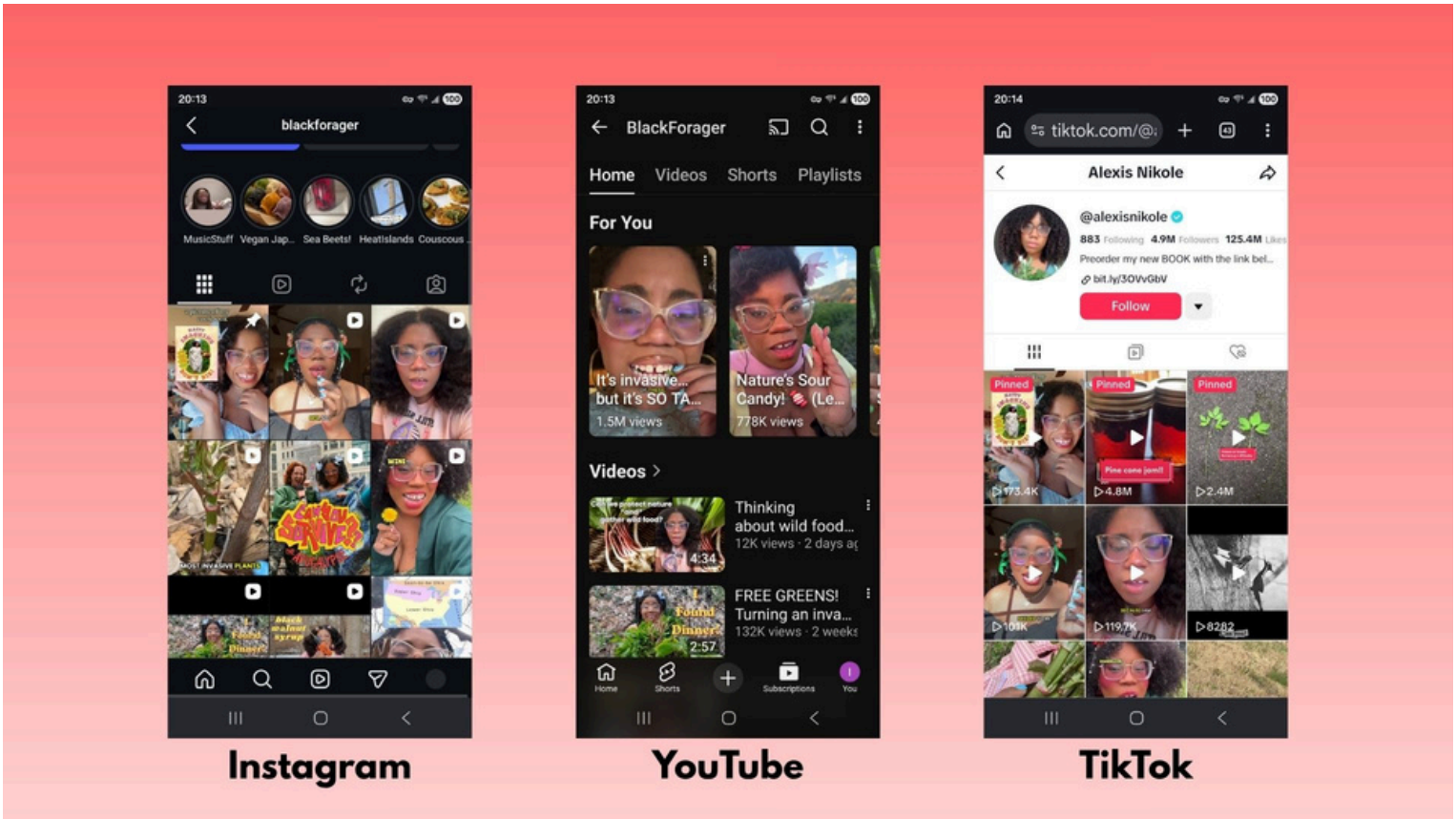
Apr 11 9:54pm | Last reply Apr 12 10:07pm

The influencer I chose to focus on is Alexis Nikole Nelson, also known as the Black Forager. Her handles are @BlackForager and @alexisnikole. She is best known for posting videos about foraging, where she identifies wild ingredients, explains their historical and cultural uses, and demonstrates how to cook with them. Many of her videos follow a consistent format, including a recurring segment where she presents two plants, one edible and one not, and asks viewers to guess before revealing the answer.

She is active on multiple platforms:
YouTube - 917K subscribers
Instagram - 2.7M followers
TikTok - 4.9MFollowers
Twitter - 75.7K Followers

She uses TikTok, YouTube, and Instagram similarly by posting the same short-form videos across platforms. The main difference is that YouTube also includes longer-form content, while Instagram occasionally incorporates static posts like screenshots of her Twitter posts. Her strategy is mostly consistent across platforms, with short-form videos designed to work across TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube Shorts. This suggests she is not heavily tailoring content to each platform's specific affordances, but instead creating platform-flexible content that can be distributed widely without major changes.

One pattern I noticed in Black Forager's content is that she tends to reuse the same videos across multiple platforms. It can seem like she is just cross-posting but that is intentional and strategic. Her content is built in a way that works across TikTok, Instagram, and other platforms without needing major changes, which helps maintain consistency in her brand and message. Her videos also follow a really consistent structure. Most of them start with a hook, then move into identifying a plant, explaining its background or safety, and ending with some kind of preparation or reaction. By making her content both educational and entertaining she is able to keep people engaged while also teaching them something new.

I haven't personally seen Black Forager work with brands in the videos I've watched, which may reflect a selective approach to partnerships. Her audience likely skews toward people who value sustainability and authenticity (psychographics), so brand alignment would only work with companies that match those values rather than mainstream or highly commercial products.